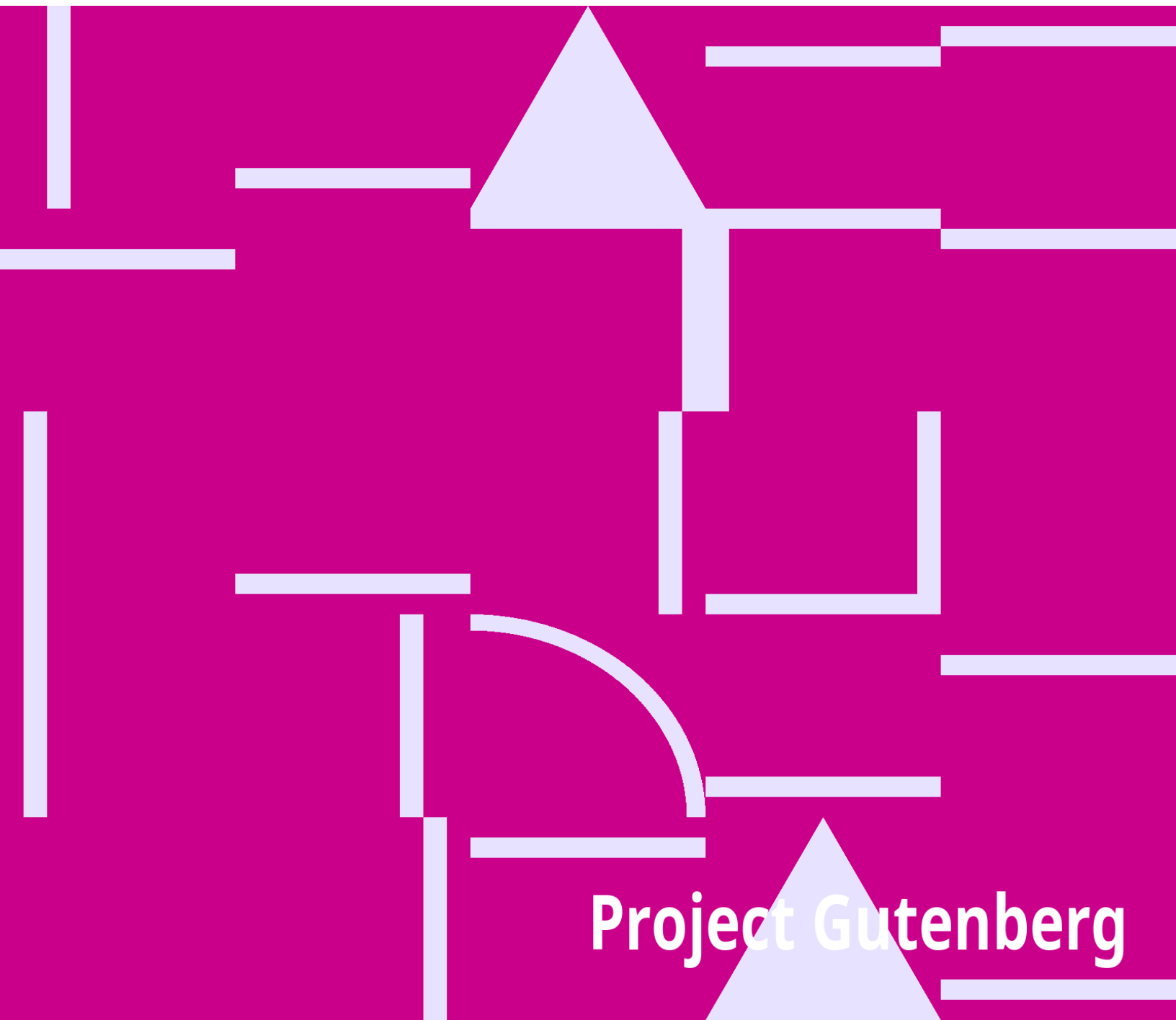


Graded Poetry: Third Year

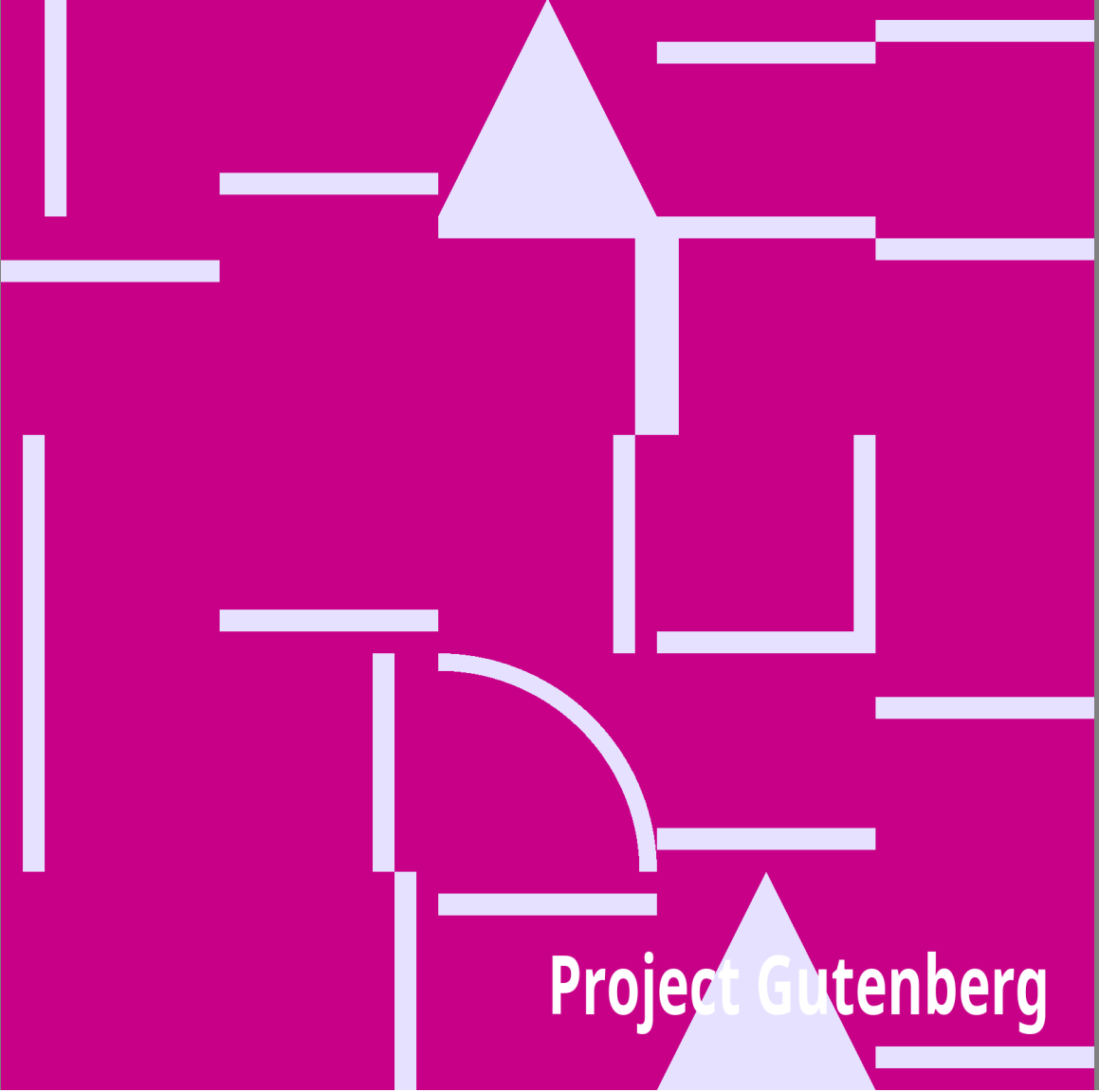
Katherine Devereux Blake and Georgia

An abstract geometric pattern composed of various white lines and shapes on a magenta background. The pattern includes several horizontal and vertical lines of varying lengths, some forming right angles. There are also two light purple triangles: one pointing upwards in the upper-middle section and another pointing downwards in the lower-right section. A white quarter-circle arc is located in the lower-left area. The overall composition is modern and minimalist.

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Graded Poetry: Third Year

Katherine Devereux Blake and Georgia

An abstract geometric pattern on a magenta background. It features various white shapes including horizontal and vertical lines, a large upward-pointing triangle, a quarter-circle arc, and a smaller upward-pointing triangle at the bottom. The pattern is framed by a grey border on the left and top.

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK GRADED
POETRY: THIRD YEAR ***

GRADED POETRY

THIRD YEAR

EDITED BY

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PRINCIPAL GIRLS' DEPARTMENT PUBLIC SCHOOL NO. 6,
NEW YORK CITY

AND

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INTRODUCTION

POETRY is the chosen language of childhood and youth. The baby repeats words again and again for the mere joy of their sound: the melody of nursery rhymes gives a delight which is quite independent of the meaning of the words. Not until youth approaches maturity is there an equal pleasure in the rounded periods of elegant prose. It is in childhood therefore that the young mind should be stored with poems whose rhythm will be a present delight and whose beautiful thoughts will not lose their charm in later years.

The selections for the lowest grades are addressed primarily to the feeling for verbal beauty, the recognition of which in the mind of the child is fundamental to the plan of this work. The editors have felt that the inclusion of critical notes in these little books intended for elementary school children would be not only superfluous, but, in the degree in which critical comment drew the child's attention from the text, subversive of the desired result. Nor are there any notes on methods. The best way to teach children to love a poem is to read it inspiringly to them. The French say: "The ear is the pathway to the heart." A poem should be so read that it will sing itself in the hearts of the listening children.

In the brief biographies appended to the later books the human element has been brought out. An effort has been made to call attention to the education of the poet and his equipment for his life work rather than to the literary qualities of his style.

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The poems by Longfellow, Whittier, Alice Cary, J. T. Fields, and Frank Dempster Sherman are published by special arrangement with the publishers, Messrs. Houghton, Mifflin, & Company.

THIRD YEAR—FIRST HALF

EDWARD LEAR

ENGLAND, 1812-1888

The Owl and the Pussy-Cat

The Owl and the Pussy-Cat went to sea
In a beautiful pea-green boat.
They took some honey, and plenty of money
Wrapped up in a five-pound note.
The Owl looked up to the moon above, 5
And sang to a small guitar,
"O lovely Pussy! O Pussy, my love!
What a beautiful Pussy you are,—
You are;
What a beautiful Pussy you are!" 10

Pussy said to the Owl, "You elegant fowl!
How wonderful sweet you sing!
Oh let us be married,—too long we have tarried,—
But what shall we do for a ring?"
They sailed away for a year and a day
To the land where the Bong-tree grows,
And there in a wood, a piggy-wig stood 5
With a ring in the end of his nose,—
His nose;
With a ring in the end of his nose.

"Dear Pig, are you willing to sell for one shilling
Your ring?" Said the piggy, "I will." 10
So they took it away, and were married next day
By the turkey who lives on the hill.
They dined upon mince and slices of quince,
Which they ate with a runcible spoon,

And hand in hand, on the edge of the sand, 15
They danced by the light of the moon,—
The moon;
They danced by the light of the moon.

WILLIAM ALLINGHAM

IRELAND, 1828-1889

Wishing

Ring ting! I wish I were a Primrose,
A bright yellow Primrose, blowing in the spring!
The stooping bough above me,
The wandering bee to love me,
The fern and moss to creep across, 5
And the Elm-tree for our king!

Nay,—stay! I wish I were an Elm-tree,
A great lofty Elm-tree, with green leaves gay!
The winds would set them dancing,
The sun and moonshine glance in, 10
And birds would house among the boughs,
And sweetly sing.

Oh—no! I wish I were a Robin,—
A Robin, or a little Wren, everywhere to go,
Through forest, field, or garden, 15
And ask no leave or pardon,
Till winter comes with icy thumbs
To ruffle up our wing!

Well,—tell! where should I fly to,
Where go sleep in the dark wood or dell?
Before the day was over, 5
Home must come the rover,
For mother's kiss,—sweeter this
Than any other thing.

WILLIAM BLAKE

ENGLAND, 1757-1827

The Piper

Piping down the valleys wild,
Piping songs of pleasant glee, 10
On a cloud I saw a child,
And he, laughing, said to me:

"Pipe a song about a lamb."
So I piped with merry cheer,
"Piper, pipe that song again." 15
So I piped; he wept to hear.

"Drop thy pipe, thy happy pipe,
Sing thy songs of happy cheer."
So I sung the same again,
While he wept with joy to hear.

"Piper, sit thee down and write 5
In a book that all may read."
So he vanish'd from my sight;
And I pluck'd a hollow reed,

And I made a rural pen,
And I stain'd the water clear, 10
And I wrote my happy songs
Every child may joy to hear.

CHRISTINA G. ROSSETTI

ENGLAND, 1830-1894

A Year's Windfalls

On the wind of January
Down flits the snow,
Traveling from the frozen North 15
As cold as it can blow.
Poor robin redbreast,
Look where he comes;
Let him in to feel your fire,
And toss him of your crumbs.

On the wind in February 5
Snowflakes float still,
Half inclined to turn to rain,
Nipping, dripping, chill.
Then the thaws swell the streams,
And swollen rivers swell the sea:— 10
If the winter ever ends
How pleasant it will be.

In the wind of windy March
The catkins drop down,
Curly, caterpillar-like, 15
Curious green and brown.
With concourse of nest-building birds
And leaf-buds by the way,
We begin to think of flower
And life and nuts some day. 20

With the gusts of April

Rich fruit-tree blossoms fall,
On the hedged-in orchard-green,
From the southern wall.
Apple trees and pear trees
Shed petals white or pink,
Plum trees and peach trees; 5
While sharp showers sink and sink.

Little brings the May breeze
Beside pure scent of flowers,
While all things wax and nothing wanes
In lengthening daylight hours. 10
Across the hyacinth beds
The wind lags warm and sweet,
Across the hawthorn tops,
Across the blades of wheat.

In the wind of sunny June 15
Thrives the red rose crop,
Every day fresh blossoms blow
While the first leaves drop;
White rose and yellow rose
And moss rose choice to find, 20
And the cottage cabbage rose
Not one whit behind.

On the blast of scorched July
Drives the pelting hail,
From thunderous lightning-clouds, that blot
Blue heaven grown lurid-pale.
Weedy waves are tossed ashore, 5
Sea-things strange to sight
Gasp upon the barren shore
And fade away in light.

In the parching August wind
Cornfields bow the head, 10

Sheltered in round valley depths,
On low hills outspread.
Early leaves drop loitering down
Weightless on the breeze,
First fruits of the year's decay 15
From the withering trees.

In brisk wind of September
The heavy-headed fruits
Shake upon their bending boughs
And drop from the shoots; 20
Some glow golden in the sun,
Some show green and streaked,
Some set forth a purple bloom,
Some blush rosy-cheeked.

In strong blast of October 5
At the equinox,
Stirred up in his hollow bed
Broad ocean rocks;
Plunge the ships on his bosom,
Leaps and plunges the foam, 10
It's oh! for mothers' sons at sea,
That they were safe at home.

In slack wind of November
The fog forms and shifts;
All the world comes out again 15
When the fog lifts.
Loosened from their sapless twigs
Leaves drop with every gust;
Drifting, rustling, out of sight
In the damp or dust. 20

Last of all, December,
The year's sands nearly run,
Speeds on the shortest day

Curtails the sun;
With its bleak raw wind
Lays the last leaves low,
Brings back the nightly frosts, 5
Brings back the snow.

MARY HOWITT

ENGLAND, 1804-1888

The Voice of Spring

I am coming, I am coming!
Hark! the little bee is humming;
See, the lark is soaring high
In the blue and sunny sky;10
And the gnats are on the wing,
Wheeling round in airy ring.

See, the yellow catkins cover
All the slender willows over!
And on the banks of mossy green15
Starlike primroses are seen;
And, their clustering leaves below,
White and purple violets blow.

Hark! the new-born lambs are bleating,
And the cawing rooks are meeting
In the elms,—a noisy crowd; 5
All the birds are singing loud;
And the first white butterfly
In the sunshine dances by.

Look around thee, look around!
Flowers in all the fields abound; 10
Every running stream is bright;
All the orchard trees are white;
And each small and waving shoot
Promises sweet flowers and fruit.

Turn thine eyes to earth and heaven: 15
God for thee the spring has given,
Taught the birds their melodies,
Clothed the earth, and cleared the skies,
For thy pleasure or thy food:
Pour thy soul in gratitude.

THOMAS MILLER

ENGLAND, 1807-1874

The Spring Walk

We had a pleasant walk to-day
Over the meadows and far away,
Across the bridge by the water-mill,
By the woodside and up the hill;
And if you listen to what I say,⁵
I'll tell you what we saw to-day.

Amid a hedge, where the first leaves
Were peeping from their sheathes so sly,
We saw four eggs within a nest,
And they were blue as a summer sky.¹⁰

An elder branch dipped in the brook;
We wondered why it moved, and found
A silken-haired smooth water-rat
Nibbling, and swimming round and round.

Where daisies open'd to the sun,¹⁵
In a broad meadow, green and white,
The lambs were racing eagerly—
We never saw a prettier sight.

We saw upon the shady banks
Long rows of golden flowers shine,
And first mistook for buttercups ⁵
The star-shaped yellow celandine.

Anemones and primroses,

And the blue violets of spring,
We found, while listening by a hedge
To hear a merry plowman sing. 10

And from the earth the plow turned up
There came a sweet, refreshing smell,
Such as the lily of the vale
Sends forth from many a woodland dell.

And leaning from the old stone bridge, 15
Below, we saw our shadows lie;
And through the gloomy arches watched
The swift and fearless swallows fly.

We heard the speckle-breasted lark
As it sang somewhere out of sight, 20
And tried to find it, but the sky
Was filled with clouds of dazzling light.

We saw young rabbits near the woods
And heard the pheasant's wings go "whir";
And then we saw a squirrel leap 5
From an old oak tree to a fir.

We came back by the village fields,
A pleasant walk it was across 'em,
For all behind the houses lay
The orchards red and white with blossom. 10

Were I to tell you all we saw,
I'm sure that it would take me hours;
For the whole landscape was alive
With bees, and birds, and buds, and flowers.

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

ENGLAND, 1564-1616

"Over Hill, Over Dale"

Over hill, over dale,
Thorough bush, thorough brier,
Over park, over pale,
Thorough flood, thorough fire.
I do wander everywhere,⁵
Swifter than the moone's sphere.
And I serve the Fairy Queen,
To dew her orbs upon the green;
The cowslips tall her pensioners be,
In their gold coats spots you see,—¹⁰
Those be rubies, Fairy favors:
In those freckles live their savors.
I must go seek some dew-drops here,
And hang a pearl in every cowslip's ear.

ALFRED TENNYSON

ENGLAND, 1809-1892

The Thristle

"Summer is coming, summer is coming,
I know it, I know it, I know it.
Light again, leaf again, love again."
Yes, my wild little Poet.

Sing the new year in under the blue.⁵
Last year you sang it as gladly.
"New, new, new, new!" Is it then so new
That you should carol so madly?

"Love again, song again, nest again, young again."
Never a prophet so crazy!¹⁰
And hardly a daisy as yet, little friend,
See, there is hardly a daisy.

"Here again, here, here, here, happy year!"
O warble, unhidden, unbidden!
Summer is coming, is coming, my dear,¹⁵
And all the winters are hidden.

JANE TAYLOR

ENGLAND, 1783-1824

The Violet

Down in a green and shady bed
A modest violet grew,
Its stalk was bent, it hung its head,
As if to hide from view.

And yet it was a lovely flower, 5
Its colors bright and fair!
It might have graced a rosy bower
Instead of hiding there.

Yet there it was content to bloom
In modest tints arrayed; 10
And there diffused its sweet perfume
Within the silent shade.

Then let me to the valley go,
This pretty flower to see,
That I may also learn to grow 15
In sweet humility.

CLINTON SCOLLARD^[1]

AMERICA, 1860-

Bobolink

Bobolink—
He is here!
Spink-a-chink!
Hark, how clear
Drops the note 5
From his throat,
Where he sways
On the sprays
Of the wheat
In the heat! 10
Bobolink,
Spink-a-chink!

Bobolink
Is a beau.
See him prink! 15
Watch him go
Through the air
To his fair!
Hear him sing
On the wing,—
Sing his best
O'er her nest! 5
"Bobolink,
Spink-a-chink!"

Bobolink,
Linger long!

There's a kink 10
In your song
Like the joy
Of a boy
Left to run
In the sun,— 15
Left to play
All the day.
Bobolink,
Spink-a-chink!

FRANK DEMPSTER SHERMAN

AMERICA, 1860-

The Four Winds

In winter, when the wind I hear,
I know the clouds will disappear;
For 'tis the wind who sweeps the sky
And piles the snow in ridges high.

In spring, when stirs the wind, I know 5
That soon the crocus buds will show;
For 'tis the wind who bids them wake
And into pretty blossoms break.

In summer, when it softly blows,
Soon red I know will be the rose; 10
For 'tis the wind to her who speaks,
And brings the blushes to her cheeks.

In autumn, when the wind is up,
I know the acorn's out its cup;
For 'tis the wind who takes it out,
And plants an oak somewhere about.

LUCY LARCOM

AMERICA, 1826-1893

The Violet

Dear little violet, 5
Don't be afraid!
Lift your blue eyes
From the rock's mossy shade.

All the birds call for you,
Out of the sky; 10
May is here waiting,
And here, too, am I.

Why do you shiver so,
Violet, sweet?
Soft is the meadow grass, 15
Under my feet.

Wrapped in your hood of green,
Violet, why
Peep from your earth door,
So silent and shy?

FRANK DEMPSTER SHERMAN

AMERICA, 1860-

Pebbles

Out of a pellucid brook 5
Pebbles round and smooth I took:
Like a jewel every one
Caught a color from the sun,—
Ruby red and sapphire blue,
Emerald and onyx too, 10
Diamond and amethyst,—
Not a precious stone I missed:
Gems I held from every land
In the hollow of my hand.
Workman Water these had made 15
Patiently through sun and shade,
With the ripples of the rill
He had polished them until,
Smooth, symmetrical, and bright,
Each one sparkling in the light
Showered within its burning heart
All the lapidary's art;
And the brook seemed thus to sing: 5
Patience conquers everything!

BJÖRNSTJERNE BJÖRNSON

NORWAY, 1832-

The Tree

The Tree's early leaf buds were bursting their brown;
"Shall I take them away?" said the Frost, sweeping down.

 "No, leave them alone
 Till the blossoms have grown," 10
Prayed the Tree, while he trembled from rootlet to crown.

The Tree bore his blossoms, and all the birds sung;
"Shall I take them away?" said the Wind, as he swung.

 "No, leave them alone
 Till the berries have grown,"
Said the Tree, while his leaflets quivering hung.

The Tree bore his fruit in the midsummer glow; 5
Said the girl: "May I gather thy berries now?"

 "Yes, all thou canst see:
 Take them; all are for thee,"
Said the Tree, while he bent down his laden boughs low.

FRANK DEMPSTER SHERMAN

AMERICA, 1860-

September

Here's a lyric for September, 10
Best of all months to remember;
Month when summer breezes tell
What has happened, wood and dell,
Of the joy the year has brought,
And the changes she has wrought.
She has turned the verdure red; 5
In the blue sky overhead,
She the harvest moon has hung,
Like a silver boat among
Shoals of stars—bright jewels set
In the earth's blue coronet; 10
She has brought the orchard's fruit
To repay the robin's flute
Which has gladdened half the year
With a music liquid, clear;
And she makes the meadow grass 15
Catch the sunbeams as they pass,
Till the autumn's floor is rolled
With a fragrant cloth of gold.

CHRISTINA ROSSETTI

ENGLAND, 1830-1894

The Swallow

Fly away, fly away, over the sea,
Sun-loving swallow, for summer is done.
Come again, come again, come back to me,
Bringing the summer, and bringing the sun.

When you come hurrying home o'er the sea, 5
Then we are certain that winter is past;
Cloudy and cold though your pathway may be,
Summer and sunshine will follow you fast.

LYDIA MARIA CHILD

AMERICA, 1802-1880

Thanksgiving Day

Over the river and through the wood,
To grandfather's house we go; 10
The horse knows the way
To carry the sleigh
Through the white and drifted snow.

Over the river and through the wood—
Oh, how the wind does blow! 5
It stings the toes
And bites the nose,
As over the ground we go.

Over the river and through the wood,
To have a first-rate play; 10
Hear the bells ring,
"Ting-a-ling-ding!"
Hurrah for Thanksgiving Day!

Over the river and through the wood,
Trot fast, my dapple-gray! 15
Spring over the ground,
Like a hunting hound!
For this is Thanksgiving Day.

Over the river and through the wood,
And straight through the barn-yard gate. 20
We seem to go
Extremely slow—

It is so hard to wait!

Over the river and through the wood—

Now grandmother's cap I spy! 5

Hurrah for the fun!

Is the pudding done?

Hurrah for the pumpkin pie!

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW

AMERICA, 1807-1882

Hiawatha's Childhood

By the shores of Gitche Gumee,
By the shining Big-Sea-Water, 10
Stood the wigwam of Nokomis,
Daughter of the Moon, Nokomis.
Dark behind it rose the forest,
Rose the black and gloomy pine-trees,
Rose the firs with cones upon them; 15
Bright before it beat the water,
Beat the clear and sunny water,
Beat the shining Big-Sea-Water.
There the wrinkled old Nokomis
Nursed the little Hiawatha,
Rocked him in his linden cradle,
Bedded soft in moss and rushes, 5
Safely bound with reindeer sinews;
Stilled his fretful wail by saying,
"Hush! the Naked Bear will hear thee!"
Lulled him into slumber, singing,
"Ewa-yea! my little owl! 10
Who is this, that lights the wigwam?
With his great eyes lights the wigwam?
Ewa-yea! my little owl!"
Many things Nokomis taught him
Of the stars that shine in heaven; 15
Showed him Ishkoodah, the comet,
Ishkoodah, with fiery tresses;
Showed the Death-Dance of the spirits,
Warriors with their plumes and war-clubs,

Flaring far away to northward 20
In the frosty nights of Winter;
Showed the broad white road in heaven,
Pathway of the ghosts, the shadows,
Running straight across the heavens,
Crowded with the ghosts, the shadows.
At the door on summer evenings,
Sat the little Hiawatha;
Heard the whispering of the pine-trees, 5
Heard the lapping of the water,
Sounds of music, words of wonder;
"Minne-wawa!" said the pine-trees,
"Mudway-aushka!" said the water.
Saw the fire-fly, Wah-wah-taysee, 10
Flitting through the dusk of evening,
With the twinkle of its candle
Lighting up the brakes and bushes.
And he sang the song of children,
Sang the song Nokomis taught him: 15
"Wah-wah-taysee, little fire-fly,
Little, flitting, white-fire insect,
Little, dancing, white-fire creature,
Light me with your little candle,
Ere upon my bed I lay me, 20
Ere in sleep I close my eyelids!"
Saw the moon rise from the water,
Rippling, rounding from the water,
Saw the flecks and shadows on it,
Whispered, "What is that, Nokomis?"
And the good Nokomis answered:
"Once a warrior, very angry,
Seized his grandmother, and threw her 5
Up into the sky at midnight;
Right against the moon he threw her;
"Tis her body that you see there."
Saw the rainbow in the heaven,
In the eastern sky the rainbow, 10

Whispered, "What is that, Nokomis?"
And the good Nokomis answered:
"'Tis the heaven of flowers you see there:
All the wild-flowers of the forest,
All the lilies of the prairie, 15
When on earth they fade and perish,
Blossom in that heaven above us."
When he heard the owls at midnight,
Hooting, laughing in the forest,
"What is that?" he cried in terror; 20
"What is that," he said, "Nokomis?"
And the good Nokomis answered:
"That is but the owl and owlet,
Talking in their native language,
Talking, scolding at each other."
Then the little Hiawatha
Learned of every bird its language,
Learned their names and all their secrets, 5
How they built their nests in summer,
Where they hid themselves in winter,
Talked with them whene'er he met them,
Called them "Hiawatha's Chickens."
Of all beasts he learned the language, 10
Learned their names and all their secrets,
How the beavers built their lodges,
Where the squirrels hid their acorns,
How the reindeer ran so swiftly,
Why the rabbit was so timid, 15
Talked with them whene'er he met them,
Called them "Hiawatha's Brothers."

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW

AMERICA, 1807-1882

Hiawatha's Sailing

"Give me of your bark, O Birch Tree!
Of your yellow bark, O Birch Tree!
Growing by the rushing river,
Tall and stately in the valley!
I a light canoe will build me, 5
Build a swift Cheemaun for sailing,
That shall float upon the river,
Like a yellow leaf in autumn,
Like a yellow water lily!

"Lay aside your cloak, O Birch Tree! 10
Lay aside your white skin wrapper,
For the summer time is coming,
And the sun is warm in heaven,
And you need no white skin wrapper!"

Thus aloud cried Hiawatha 15
In the solitary forest,
By the rushing Taquamenaw,
When the birds were singing gaily,
In the Moon of Leaves were singing,
And the Sun, from sleep awaking,
Started up and said, "Behold me!
Geezis, the great Sun, behold me!"

And the tree with all its branches
Rustled in the breeze of morning, 5
Saying, with a sigh of patience,
"Take my cloak, O Hiawatha!"

With his knife the tree he girdled;
Just beneath its lowest branches,

Just above the roots, he cut it, 10
Till the sap came oozing outward;
Down the trunk, from top to bottom,
Sheer he cleft the bark asunder,
With a wooden wedge he raised it,
Stripped it from the trunk unbroken. 15

"Give me of your boughs, O Cedar!
Of your strong and pliant branches,
My canoe to make more steady,
Make more strong and firm beneath me!"

Through the summit of the Cedar 20
Went a sound, a cry of horror,
Went a murmur of resistance;
But it whispered, bending downward,
"Take my boughs, O Hiawatha!"

Down he hewed the boughs of cedar,
Shaped them straightway to a framework,
Like two bows he formed and shaped them,
Like two bended bows together. 5

"Give me of your roots, O Tamarack!
Of your fibrous roots, O Larch Tree!
My canoe to bind together,
So to bind the ends together
That the water may not enter, 10
That the river may not wet me!"

And the Larch with all its fibers,
Shivered in the air of morning,
Touched his forehead with its tassels,
Said, with one long sigh of sorrow, 15
"Take them all, O Hiawatha!"

From the earth he tore the fibers,
Tore the tough roots of the Larch Tree,
Closely sewed the bark together,
Bound it closely to the framework. 20

"Give me of your balm, O Fir Tree!
Of your balsam and your resin,
So to close the seams together

That the water may not enter,
That the river may not wet me!"

And the Fir Tree, tall and somber,
Sobbed through all its robes of darkness,
Rattled like a shore with pebbles, 5
Answered wailing, answered weeping,
"Take my balm, O Hiawatha!"

And he took the tears of balsam,
Took the resin of the Fir Tree,
Seamed therewith each seam and fissure, 10
Made each crevice safe from water.

"Give me of your quills, O Hedgehog!
All your quills, O Kagh, the Hedgehog!
I will make a necklace of them,
Make a girdle for my beauty, 15
And two stars to deck her bosom!"

From a hollow tree the Hedgehog
With his sleepy eyes looked at him,
Shot his shining quills, like arrows,
Saying, with a drowsy murmur, 20
Through the tangle of his whiskers,
"Take my quills, O Hiawatha!"

From the ground the quills he gathered,
All the little shining arrows,
Stained them red and blue and yellow,
With the juice of roots and berries;
Into his canoe he wrought them,
Round its waist a shining girdle, 5
Round its bows a gleaming necklace,
On its breast two stars resplendent.

Thus the Birch Canoe was builded,
In the valley, by the river,
In the bosom of the forest; 10
And the forest's life was in it,
All its mystery and its magic,
All the lightness of the birch tree,
All the toughness of the cedar,

All the larch's supple sinews; 15
And it floated on the river
Like a yellow leaf in autumn,
Like a yellow water lily.

Paddles none had Hiawatha,
Paddles none he had or needed, 20
For his thoughts as paddles served him,
And his wishes served to guide him;
Swift or slow at will he glided,
Veered to right or left at pleasure.

SABINE BARING-GOULD

ENGLAND, 1834-

Child's Evening Prayer

Now the day is over, 5
Night is drawing nigh,
Shadows of the evening
Steal across the sky.

Now the darkness gathers,
Stars begin to peep,
Birds and beasts and flowers
Soon will be asleep.

Through the long night-watches
May Thine angels spread 10
Their white wings above me,
Watching round my bed.

When the morning wakens,
Then may I arise
Pure and fresh and sinless 15
In Thy holy eyes.

THIRD YEAR—SECOND HALF

Columbia, the Gem of the Ocean

O, Columbia, the gem of the ocean,
The home of the brave and the free,
The shrine of each patriot's devotion,
A world offers homage to thee;
Thy mandates make heroes assemble, 5
When Liberty's form stands in view;
Thy banners make tyranny tremble,
When borne by the red, white, and blue,
When borne by the red, white, and blue,
When borne by the red, white, and blue, 10
Thy banners make tyranny tremble,
When borne by the red, white, and blue.

When war wing'd its wide desolation,
And threaten'd the land to deform,
The ark then of freedom's foundation, 15
Columbia rode safe thro' the storm:
With the garlands of vict'ry around her,
When so proudly she bore her brave crew,
With her flag proudly floating before her,
The boast of the red, white, and blue,
The boast of the red, white, and blue, 5
The boast of the red, white, and blue,
With her flag proudly floating before her
The boast of the red, white, and blue.

The star-spangled banner bring hither,
O'er Columbia's true sons let it wave; 10
May the wreaths they have won never wither,
Nor its stars cease to shine on the brave.

May the service united ne'er sever,
But hold to their colors so true;
The army and navy forever, 15
Three cheers for the red, white, and blue,
Three cheers for the red, white, and blue,
Three cheers for the red, white, and blue,
The army and navy forever,
Three cheers for the red, white, and blue. 20

ROBERT HERRICK

ENGLAND, 1591-1674

Corinna going a-Maying

Get up, get up, for shame the blooming morn
Upon her wings presents the gods unshorn.
 See how Aurora throws her fair,
 Fresh-quilted colors through the air;
 Get up, sweet slug-a-bed, and see 5
 The dew-bespangled herb and tree.

Each flower has wept, and bowed toward the East
Above an hour since, yet you are not drest,
 Nay not so much as out of bed,
 When all the birds have matins said, 10
 And sung their thankful hymns; 'tis sin,
 Nay, profanation to keep in,
When as a thousand virgins on this day
Spring sooner than the lark to fetch in May.

Come, my Corinna, come, and coming, mark
How each field turns a street—each street a park,
 Made green and trimmed with trees! see how
 Devotion gives each house a bough,
 Or branch! each porch, each door, ere this 5
 An ark, a tabernacle is,
Made up of whitethorn neatly interwove,
As if he were those cooler shades of love.
 Can such delights be in the street
 And open fields, and we not see't? 10
 Come we'll abroad, and let's obey
 The proclamation made for May.

And sin no more, as we have done, by staying,
But, my Corinna! come, let's go a-Maying.

JOHN KEATS

ENGLAND, 1795-1821

Sweet Peas

Here are sweet peas, on tiptoe for a flight:
With wings of gentle flush o'er delicate white,
And taper fingers catching at all things,
To bind them all about with tiny rings.
Linger awhile upon some bending planks 5
That lean against a streamlet's rushy banks,
And watch intently Nature's gentle doings,
They will be found softer than ringdove's cooings.
How silent comes the water round that bend!
Not the minutest whisper does it send 10
To the o'erhanging sallows: blades of grass
Slowly across the chequer'd shadows pass.

EMILY HUNTINGTON MILLER

AMERICA, 1862-

The Bluebird

I know the song that the bluebird is singing,
Out in the apple-tree where he is swinging:
Brave little fellow! the skies may be dreary:
Nothing cares he while his heart is so cheery.

Hark! how the music leaps out from his throat— 5
Hark! was there ever so merry a note?
Listen awhile, and you'll hear what he's saying,
Up in the apple-tree, swinging and swaying.

"Dear little blossoms, down under the snow,
You must be weary of winter, I know; 10
Hark while I sing you a message of cheer—
Summer is coming! and *spring-time* is here!

"Little white snowdrop! I pray you, arise;
Bright yellow crocus! come, open your eyes;
Sweet little violets, hid from the cold, 5
Put on your mantles of purple and gold:
Daffodils! daffodils! say, do you hear?—
Summer is coming! and *spring-time* is here!"

ROBERT LOUIS STEVENSON

SCOTLAND, 1850-1894

Where go the Boats?

Dark brown is the river,
Golden is the sand, 10
It flows along forever,
With trees on either hand.

Green leaves a-floating,
Castles of the foam,
Boats of mine a-boating—
Where will all come home?

On goes the river 5
And out past the mill,
Away down the valley,
Away down the hill.

Away down the river,
A hundred miles or more, 10
Other little children
Shall bring my boats ashore.

CHARLES LAMB, MARY LAMB

ENGLAND, 1775-1834, ENGLAND, 1764-1847

The Magpie's Nest

When the arts in their infancy were,
In a fable of old 'tis expressed
A wise magpie constructed that rare 15
Little house for young birds, called a nest.

This was talked of the whole country round;
You might hear it on every bough sung;
"Now no longer upon the rough ground
Will fond mothers brood over their young:

"For the magpie with exquisite skill 5
Has invented a moss-covered cell
Within which a whole family will
In the utmost security dwell."

To her mate did each female bird say:
"Let us fly to the magpie, my dear; 10
If she will but teach us the way,
A nest we will build us up here.

"It's a thing that's close arched overhead,
With a hole made to creep out and in;
We, my bird, might make just such a bed 15
If we only knew how to begin."

To the magpie soon all the birds went,
And in modest terms made their request,
That she would be pleased to consent

To teach them to build up a nest.

She replied: "I will show you the way,
So observe everything that I do:
First, two sticks 'cross each other I lay—" 5
"To be sure," said the crow, "why I knew

"It must be begun with two sticks,
And I thought that they crossed should be."
Said the pie, "Then some straw and moss mix
In the way you now see done by me." 10

"Oh, yes, certainly," said the jackdaw,
"That must follow, of course, I have thought;
Though I never before building saw,
I guessed that without being taught."
"More moss, more straw, and feathers, I place 15
In this manner," continued the pie.
"Yes, no doubt, madam, that is the case;
Though no builder myself, so thought I."

Whatever she taught them beside,
In his turn every bird of them said,
Though the nest-making art he ne'er tried, 5
He had just such a thought in his head.

Still the pie went on showing her art,
Till the nest she had built up halfway;
She no more of her skill would impart,
But in her anger went fluttering away. 10

And this speech in their hearing she made,
As she perched o'er their heads on a tree:
"If ye all were well skilled in my trade,
Pray, why came ye to learn it of me?"

MARGARET VANDEGRIFT

AMERICA, 1845-

The Sandman

The rosy clouds float overhead,
The sun is going down;
And now the sandman's gentle tread
Comes stealing through the town.
"White sand, white sand," he softly cries, 5
And as he shakes his hand,
Straightway there lies on babies' eyes
His gift of shining sand.
Blue eyes, gray eyes, black eyes, and brown,
As shuts the rose, they softly close, when he goes through
the town,10

From sunny beaches far away—
Yes, in another land—
He gathers up at break of day
His store of shining sand.
No tempests beat that shore remote, 15
No ships may sail that way;
His little boat alone may float
Within that lovely bay.
Blue eyes, gray eyes, black eyes, and brown,
As shuts the rose, they softly close, when he goes through
the town.

He smiles to see the eyelids close 5
Above the happy eyes;
And every child right well he knows,—
Oh, he is very wise!

But if, as he goes through the land,
 A naughty baby cries, 10
His other hand takes dull gray sand
 To close the wakeful eyes.
Blue eyes, gray eyes, black eyes, and brown,
As shuts the rose, they softly close, when he goes through
the town.

So when you hear the sandman's song 15
 Sound through the twilight sweet,
Be sure you do not keep him long
 A-waiting on the street.
Lie softly down, dear little head,
 Rest quiet, busy hands,
Till, by your bed his good night said,
 He strews the shining sands. 5
Blue eyes, gray eyes, black eyes, and brown,
As shuts the rose, they softly close, when he goes through
the town.

MARY HOWITT

ENGLAND, 1804-1888

The Fairies of the Caldon-Low

A MIDSUMMER LEGEND

"And where have you been, my Mary,
And where have you been from me?"
"I've been to the top of the Caldon-Low, 10
The midsummer night to see!"

"And what did you see, my Mary,
All up on the Caldon-Low?"
"I saw the blithe sunshine come down,
And I saw the merry winds blow." 15
"And what did you hear, my Mary,
All up on the Caldon Hill?"
"I heard the drops the water made,
And I heard the corn-ears fill."

"Oh, tell me all, my Mary— 5
All, all that ever you know;
For you must have seen the fairies
Last night on the Caldon-Low."

"Then take me on your knee, mother,
And listen, mother of mine: 10
A hundred fairies danced last night,
And the harpers they were nine;

"And merry was the glee of the harp-strings,
And their dancing feet so small;

But, oh! the sound of their talking 15
Was merrier far than all!"

"And what were the words, my Mary,
That you did hear them say?"

"I'll tell you all, my mother,
But let me have my way. 20

"And some they played with the water,
And rolled it down the hill;

'And this,' they said, 'shall speedily turn
The poor old miller's mill;

"For there has been no water 5
Ever since the first of May;
And a busy man shall the miller be
By the dawning of the day!

"Oh, the miller, how he will laugh,
When he sees the mill-dam rise! 10
The jolly old miller, how he will laugh
Till the tears fill both his eyes!"

"And some they seized the little winds,
That sounded over the hill,
And each put a horn into his mouth, 15
And blew so sharp and shrill:

"And there,' said they, 'the merry winds go
Away from every horn;
And those shall clear the mildew dank
From the blind old widow's corn: 20

"Oh, the poor blind widow—
Though she has been blind so long,
She'll be merry enough when the mildew's gone,
And the corn stands stiff and strong!"

"And some they brought the brown linseed, 5

And flung it down from the Low:
'And this,' said they, 'by the sunrise,
In the weaver's croft shall grow!

"Oh, the poor lame weaver!
How he will laugh outright 10
When he sees his dwindling flax-field
All full of flowers by night!"

"And then up spoke a brownie,
With a long beard on his chin:
'I have spun up all the tow,' said he, 15
'And I want some more to spin.

"I've spun a piece of hempen cloth,
And I want to spin another—
A little sheet for Mary's bed,
And an apron for her mother.'

"And with that I could not help but laugh,
And I laughed out loud and free;
And then on top of the Caldon-Low 5
There was no one left but me.

"And all on top of the Caldon-Low
The mists were cold and gray,
And nothing I saw but the mossy stones
That round about me lay. 10

"But, as I came down from the hill-top,
I heard, afar below,
How busy the jolly miller was,
And how merry the wheel did go.

"And I peeped into the widow's field, 15
And sure enough were seen
The yellow ears of the mildewed corn

All standing stiff and green!

"And down by the weaver's croft I stole,
To see if the flax were high;
But I saw the weaver at his gate,
With the good news in his eye!

"Now this is all I heard, mother, 5
And all that I did see;
So, prithee, make my bed, mother,
For I'm tired as I can be!"

FELICIA DOROTHEA HEMANS

ENGLAND, 1793-1835

Night-scented Flowers

"Call back your odors, lonely flowers,
From the night-wind call them back; 10
And fold your leaves till the laughing hours
Come forth in the sunbeam's track.

"The lark lies couched in her grassy nest,
And the honey-bee is gone,
And all bright things are away to rest; 15
Why watch ye here alone?"

"Nay, let our shadowy beauty bloom
When the stars give quiet light,
And let us offer our faint perfume
On the silent shrine of night.

"Call it not wasted, the scent we lend 5
To the breeze when no step is nigh:
Oh! thus forever the earth should send
Her grateful breath on high!

"And love us as emblems, night's dewy flowers,
Of hopes unto sorrow given, 10
That spring through the gloom of the darkest hours,
Looking alone to heaven."

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER

AMERICA, 1807-1892

Indian Summer

From gold to gray
Our mild, sweet day
Of Indian summer fades too soon; 15
But tenderly
Above the sea
Hangs, white and calm, the hunter's moon.

In its pale fire
The village spire 5
Shows like the zodiac's spectral lance;
The painted walls
Whereon it falls
Transfigured stand in marble trance.

ALICE CARY

AMERICA, 1820-1871

November

The leaves are fading and falling, 10
The winds are rough and wild,
The birds have ceased their calling,
But let me tell you, my child,

Though day by day, as it closes,
Doth darker and colder grow, 15
The roots of the bright red roses
Will keep alive in the snow.

And when the winter is over
The boughs will get new leaves,
The quail will come back to the clover,
And the swallow back to the eaves.

The robin will wear on his bosom 5
A vest that is bright and new,
And the loveliest wayside blossoms
Will shine with the sun and dew.

The leaves to-day are whirling,
The brooks are all dry and dumb, 10
But let me tell you, my darling,
The spring will be sure to come.

There must be rough, cold weather,
And winds and rains so wild;
Not all good things together 15

Come to us here, my child.

So when some dear joy loses
Its beauteous summer glow,
Think how the roots of the roses
Are kept alive in the snow. 20

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER

The Frost Spirit

He comes,—he comes,—the Frost Spirit comes! You may trace
his footsteps now

On the naked woods and the blasted fields and the brown hill's
withered brow.

He has smitten the leaves of the gray old trees where their
pleasant green came forth,
And the winds, which follow wherever he goes, have shaken
them down to earth.

He comes,—he comes,—the Frost Spirit comes!—from the
frozen Labrador,— 5

From the icy bridge of the Northern seas, which the white bear
wanders o'er,—

Where the fisherman's sail is stiff with ice, and the luckless
forms below

In the sunless cold of the lingering night into marble statues
grow!

He comes,—he comes,—the Frost Spirit comes!—on the
rushing Northern blast,

And the dark Norwegian pines have bowed as his fearful breath
went past.

With an unscorched wing he has hurried on, where the fires of
Hecla glow

On the darkly beautiful sky above and the ancient ice below.

He comes,—he comes,—the Frost Spirit comes!—and the quiet
lake shall feel 5

The torpid touch of his glazing breath, and ring to the skater's
heel;

And the streams which danced on the broken rocks, or sang to
the leaning grass,
Shall bow again to their winter chain, and in mournful silence
pass.

He comes,—he comes,—the Frost Spirit comes!—let us meet
him as we may,
And turn with the light of the parlor-fire his evil power away;
And gather closer the circle round, when that firelight dances
high,
And laugh at the shriek of the baffled Fiend as his sounding
wing goes by!

ALFRED TENNYSON

ENGLAND, 1809-1892

The Owl

I

When cats run home and the light is come
And the dew is cold upon the ground, 5
And the far-off stream is dumb,
And the whirring sail goes round,
And the whirring sail goes round;
Alone and warming his five wits,
The white owl in the belfry sits. 10

II

When merry milkmaids click the latch,
And rarely smells the new-mown hay,
And the cock hath sung beneath the thatch
Twice or thrice his roundelay,
Twice or thrice his roundelay;
Alone and warming his five wits,
The white owl in the belfry sits. 5

GEORGE MACDONALD

SCOTLAND, 1824-

The Wind and the Moon

Said the Wind to the Moon, "I will blow you out.
You stare
In the air
Like a ghost in a chair,
Always looking what I am about; 10
I hate to be watched; I will blow you out."

The Wind blew hard, and out went the Moon.
So, deep,
On a heap
Of clouds, to sleep,
Down lay the Wind, and slumbered soon—
Muttering low, "I've done for that Moon."

He turned in his bed; she was there again! 5
On high
In the sky,
With her one ghost eye,
The Moon shone white and alive and plain.
Said the Wind—"I will blow you out again." 10

The Wind blew hard, and the Moon grew dim.
"With my sledge
And my wedge
I have knocked off her edge!
If only I blow right fierce and grim, 15
The creature will soon be dimmer than dim."

He blew and blew, and she thinned to a thread.
"One puff
More's enough
To blow her to snuff!
One good puff more where the last was bred, 5
And glimmer, glimmer, glum will go the thread!"

He blew a great blast and the thread was gone;
In the air
Nowhere
Was a moonbeam bare; 10
Far off and harmless the shy stars shone;
Sure and certain the Moon was gone!

The Wind he took to his revels once more;
On down
In town, 15
Like a merry mad clown,
He leaped and hallooed with whistle and roar,
"What's that?" The glimmering thread once more!

He flew in a rage—he danced and blew;
But in vain
Was the pain
Of his bursting brain; 5
For still the broader the Moon-scrap grew,
The broader he swelled his big cheeks and blew.

Slowly she grew—till she filled the night,
And shone
On her throne 10
In the sky alone,
A matchless, wonderful, silvery light,
Radiant and lovely, the Queen of the Night.

Said the Wind—"What a marvel of power am I!
With my breath, 15

Good faith!
I blew her to death—
First blew her away right out of the sky—
Then blew her in; what a strength am I!"

But the Moon she knew nothing about the affair,
For, high
In the sky, 5
With her one white eye,
Motionless, miles above the air,
She had never heard the great Wind blare.

JAMES T. FIELDS

AMERICA, 1817-1881

The Tempest

We were crowded in the cabin,
Not a soul would dare to sleep,— 10
It was midnight on the waters,
And a storm was on the deep.

'Tis a fearful thing in winter
To be shattered in the blast,
And to hear the rattling trumpet
Thunder, "Cut away the mast!"

So we shuddered there in silence,—
For the stoutest held his breath,
While the hungry sea was roaring, 5
And the breakers talked with Death.

As thus we sat in darkness,
Each one busy in his prayers,—
"We are lost!" the captain shouted,
As he staggered down the stairs. 10

But his little daughter whispered,
As she took his icy hand,
"Is not God upon the ocean,
Just the same as on the land?"

Then we kissed the little maiden, 15
And we spoke in better cheer;

And we anchored safe in harbor
When the morn was shining clear.

CLEMENT C. MOORE

AMERICA, 1779-1863

A Visit from St. Nicholas

'Twas the night before Christmas, when all through the house
Not a creature was stirring, not even a mouse;
The stockings were hung by the chimney with care,
In hopes that St. Nicholas soon would be there;
The children were nestled all snug in their beds, 5
While visions of sugar-plums danced in their heads;
And Mamma in her kerchief, and I in my cap,
Had just settled our brains for a long winter's nap,
When out on the lawn there arose such a clatter,
I sprang from my bed to see what was the matter.
Away to the window I flew like a flash,
Tore open the shutters and threw up the sash.
The moon, on the breast of the new-fallen snow,
Gave a luster of midday to objects below; 5
When, what to my wondering eyes should appear,
But a miniature sleigh, and eight tiny reindeer,
With a little old driver, so lively and quick,
I knew in a moment it must be St. Nick.
More rapid than eagles his coursers they came, 10
And he whistled, and shouted, and called them by name:
"Now, Dasher! now, Dancer! now, Prancer and Vixen!
On, Comet! on, Cupid! on, Donner and Blitzen—
To the top of the porch, to the top of the wall!
Now, dash away, dash away, dash away, all!"
As dry leaves that before the wild hurricane fly,
When they meet with an obstacle, mount to the sky,
So, up to the house-top the coursers they flew, 5

With the sleigh full of toys—and St. Nicholas, too.
And then in a twinkling I heard on the roof
The prancing and pawing of each little hoof.
As I drew in my head, and was turning around,
Down the chimney St. Nicholas came with a bound. 10
He was dressed all in fur from his head to his foot,
And his clothes were all tarnished with ashes and soot;
A bundle of toys he had flung on his back,
And he looked like a peddler just opening his pack.
His eyes how they twinkled! his dimples how merry!
His cheeks were like roses, his nose like a cherry;
His droll little mouth was drawn up like a bow, 5
And the beard on his chin was as white as the snow.
The stump of a pipe he held tight in his teeth,
And the smoke, it encircled his head like a wreath;
He had a broad face and a little round belly
That shook, when he laughed, like a bowl full of jelly. 10
He was chubby and plump—a right jolly old elf;
And I laughed when I saw him, in spite of myself.
A wink of his eye, and a twist of his head,
Soon gave me to know I had nothing to dread.
He spoke not a word, but went straight to his work,
And filled all the stockings; then turned with a jerk,
And laying his finger aside of his nose, 5
And giving a nod, up the chimney he rose.
He sprang to his sleigh, to his team gave a whistle,
And away they all flew like the down of a thistle;
But I heard him exclaim, ere he drove out of sight,
"Happy Christmas to all, and to all a good night!" 10

WILLIAM WORDSWORTH

ENGLAND, 1770-1850

Lucy Gray

Oft I had heard of Lucy Gray;
And, when I crossed the wild,
I chanced to see at break of day
The solitary child.

No mate, no comrade, Lucy knew; 5
She dwelt on a wide moor,—
The sweetest thing that ever grew
Beside a human door!

You yet may spy the fawn at play,
The hare upon the green; 10
But the sweet face of Lucy Gray
Will never more be seen.

"To-night will be a stormy night—
You to the town must go:
And take a lantern, child, to light 15
Your mother through the snow."

"That, father, will I gladly do:
'Tis scarcely afternoon—
The minster-clock has just struck two;
And yonder is the moon."

At this the father raised his hook, 5
And snapped a fagot-band;
He plied his work;—and Lucy took

The lantern in her hand.

Not blither is the mountain roe:

With many a wanton stroke 10
Her feet disperse the powdery snow,
That rises up like smoke.

The storm came on before its time,
She wandered up and down;
And many a hill did Lucy climb, 15
But never reached the town.

The wretched parents all that night
Went shouting far and wide;
But there was neither sound nor sight
To serve them for a guide. 20
At daybreak on a hill they stood
That overlooked the moor;
And thence they saw the bridge of wood,
A furlong from their door.

They wept—and, turning homeward, cried, 5
"In heaven we all shall meet!"
When in the snow the mother spied
The print of Lucy's feet.

Then downwards from the steep hill's edge
They tracked the footmarks small; 10
And through the broken hawthorn hedge,
And by the low stone wall:

And then an open field they crossed;
The marks were still the same;
They tracked them on, nor ever lost; 15
And to the bridge they came.

They follow from the snowy bank

Those footmarks, one by one,
Into the middle of the plank;
And further there were none! 20
—Yet some maintain that to this day
She is a living child;
That you may see sweet Lucy Gray
Upon the lonesome wild.

O'er rough and smooth she trips along. 5
And never looks behind;
And sings a solitary song
That whistles in the wind.

WILLIAM BRIGHTLY RANDS

ENGLAND, 1823-1880

The Wonderful World

Great, wide, wonderful, beautiful world,
With the beautiful water about you curled, 10
And the wonderful grass upon your breast—
World, you are beautifully dressed!

The wonderful air is over me,
And the wonderful wind is shaking the tree;
It walks on the water and whirls the mills, 15
And talks to itself on the tops of the hills.

You friendly earth, how far do you go,
With wheat fields that nod, and rivers that flow,
And cities and gardens, and oceans and isles,
And people upon you for thousands of miles?

Ah, you are so great and I am so small, 5
I hardly can think of you, world, at all;
And yet, when I said my prayers to-day,
A whisper within me seemed to say:
"You are more than the earth, though you're such a
dot;
You can love and think, and the world cannot." 10

WILLIAM WORDSWORTH

ENGLAND, 1770-1850

To a Child

WRITTEN IN HER ALBUM

Small service is true service while it lasts.
Of humblest friends, bright creature! scorn not
one:
The daisy, by the shadow that it casts,
Protects the lingering dewdrop from the sun.

CHRISTINA G. ROSSETTI

ENGLAND, 1830-1894

Consider

Consider
The lilies of the field whose bloom is brief:
We are as they; 5
Like them we fade away,
As doth a leaf.

Consider
The sparrows of the air of small account:
Our God doth view 10
Whether they fall or mount,—
He guards us too.

Consider
The lilies that do neither spin nor toil,
Yet are most fair: 15
What profits all this care
And all this toil?

Consider
The birds that have no barn nor harvest-weeks;
God gives them food:
Much more our Father seeks
To do us good. 5

SIR WALTER SCOTT

SCOTLAND, 1771-1832

Lullaby of an Infant Chief

Oh, hush thee, my baby, thy sire was a knight,
Thy mother a lady, both lovely and bright;
The woods and the glens from the tower which we see,
They all are belonging, dear baby, to thee.

Oh, fear not the bugle, though loudly it blows, 10
It calls but the warders that guard thy repose;
Their bows would be bended, their blades would be red,
Ere the step of a foeman draws near to thy bed.

Oh, hush thee, my baby, the time will soon come,
When thy sleep shall be broken by trumpet and drum;
Then hush thee, my darling, take rest while you may,
For strife comes with manhood, and waking with day. 5

EUGENE FIELD

AMERICA, 1850-1895

Dutch Lullaby[2]

Wynken, Blynken, and Nod one night
Sailed off in a wooden shoe—
Sailed on a river of crystal light,
Into a sea of dew.
"Where are you going, and what do you wish?" 10
The old moon asked the three.
"We have come to fish for the herring fish
That live in this beautiful sea;
Nets of silver and gold have we!"
Said Wynken,
Blynken,
And Nod. 5

The old moon laughed and sang a song,
As they rocked in the wooden shoe,
And the wind that sped them all night long
Ruffled the waves of dew.
The little stars were the herring fish 10
That lived in that beautiful sea—
"Now cast your nets wherever you wish—
Never afeard are we";
So cried the stars to the fishermen three:
Wynken, 15
Blynken,
And Nod.

All night long their nets they threw
To the stars in the twinkling foam—

Then down from the skies came the wooden shoe, 20
Bringing the fishermen home;
"Twas all so pretty a sail it seemed
As if it could not be,
And some folks thought 'twas a dream they'd
dreamed
Of sailing that beautiful sea—
But I shall name you the fishermen three: 5
 Wynken,
 Blynken,
 And Nod.

Wynken and Blynken are two little eyes:
And Nod is a little head, 10
And the wooden shoe that sailed the skies
Is a wee one's trundle-bed.
So shut your eyes while mother sings
Of wonderful sights that be,
And you shall see the beautiful things 15
As you rock in the misty sea,
Where the old shoe rocked the fishermen three:
 Wynken,
 Blynken,
 And Nod. 20

EUGENE FIELD

AMERICA, 1850-1895

The Night Wind[3]

Have you ever heard the wind go "Yoooo"?
 'Tis a pitiful sound to hear!
It seems to chill you through and through
 With a strange and speechless fear.
'Tis the voice of the night that broods outside 5
 When folks should be asleep,
And many and many's the time I've cried
To the darkness brooding far and wide
 Over the land and the deep:
 "Whom do you want, O lonely night, 10
 That you wail the long hours through?"
And the night would say in its ghostly way:
 "Yooooooooo!
 Yooooooooo!
 Yooooooooo!" 15

My mother told me long ago
 (When I was a little lad)
That when the wind went wailing so
 Somebody had been bad;
And then, when I was snug in bed,
 Whither I had been sent,
With the blankets pulled up round my head, 5
I'd think of what my mother'd said,
 And wonder what boy she meant!
And "Who's been bad to-day?" I'd ask
 Of the wind that hoarsely blew,
And the voice would say in its meaningful way: 10

"Yooooooooo!
Yooooooooo!
Yooooooooo!"

That this was true I must allow—
You'll not believe it, though! 15
Yes, though I'm quite a model now,
I was not always so.
And if you doubt what things I say,
Suppose you make the test;
Suppose, when you've been bad some day 20
And up to bed are sent away
From mother and the rest—
Suppose you ask, "Who has been bad?"
And then you'll hear what's true;
For the wind will moan in its ruefulest tone:
"Yooooooooo!
Yooooooooo! 5
Yooooooooo!"

THOMAS BAILEY ALDRICH

AMERICA, 1836-

Marjorie's Almanac[4]

Robins in the tree top,
Blossoms in the grass,
Green things a-growing
Everywhere you pass
Sudden little breezes, 5
Showers of silver dew,
Black bough and bent twig
Budding out anew;
Pine tree and willow tree,
Fringed elm, and larch,—
Don't you think that May-time's
Pleasanter than March?

Apples in the orchard 5
Mellowing one by one;
Strawberries upturning
Soft cheeks to the sun;
Roses faint with sweetness,
Lilies fair of face, 10
Drowsy scents and murmurs
Haunting every place;
Lengths of golden sunshine,
Moonlight bright as day—
Don't you think that summer's 15
Pleasanter than May?

Roger in the corn patch
Whistling negro songs;

Pussy by the hearth side
 Romp with the tongs; 20
Chestnuts in the ashes,
 Bursting through the rind;
Red leaf and gold leaf
 Rustling down the wind;
Mother "doin' peaches"
 All the afternoon,— 5
Don't you think that autumn's
 Pleasanter than June?

Little fairy snow-flakes
 Dancing in the flue;
Old Mr. Santa Claus, 10
 What is keeping you?
Twilight and firelight
 Shadows come and go;
Merry chime of sleigh bells
 Tinkling through the snow; 15
Mother knitting stockings,
 Pussy's got the ball,
Don't you think that winter's
 Pleasanter than all?

M. BETHAM EDWARDS

AMERICA, 1836-

A Child's Prayer

God make my life a little light,
Within the world to glow—
A tiny flame that burneth bright,
Wherever I may go.

God make my life a little flower, 5
That bringeth joy to all,
Content to bloom in native bower,
Although its place be small.

God make my life a little song,
That comforteth the sad, 10
That helpeth others to be strong,
And makes the singer glad.

FOOTNOTES:

[1] From "A Boy's Book of Rhyme."

[2] From "Poems of Childhood," published by Messrs. Charles Scribner's Sons.

[3] From "Poems of Childhood," published by Messrs. Charles Scribner's Sons.

[4] Selections from Thomas B. Aldrich are used by permission of, and by special arrangement with, Houghton, Mifflin & Co., publishers of his works.

Transcriber's Notes:

On pages 22 and 24 the author's location was printed in all capitals instead of small capitals. These were changed to match the rest of the text.

Page 53, the line number for line 5 was added.

Page 59, the line number 5 was moved up one line.

Page 63, single quotation mark changed to a double quotation mark. ("The lark lies)

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